

Docker & Kubernetes Production Cheatsheet (2026)

1. Docker CLI Essentials

```
# Build image with no cache
docker build --no-cache -t myapp:latest .

# Run container with environment file & restart policy
docker run -d --name myapp -p 8000:8000 --env-file .env --restart unless-stopped myapp:latest

# Cleanup unused images, volumes, and containers
docker system prune -a --volumes -f
```

2. Docker Compose Production

```
# Start stack in background
docker compose -f docker-compose.prod.yml up -d --build

# View real-time logs with timestamp
docker compose logs -f -t --tail 100
```

3. Kubernetes (kubectl) Core Commands

```
# Get pods with wide details & labels
kubectl get pods -o wide --show-labels -n production

# Execute interactive shell inside pod
kubectl exec -it pod-name -n production -- /bin/sh

# Port forward local port to remote deployment
kubectl port-forward deployment/myapp 8000:8000 -n production
```